

Wiki Onboarding Guide

What is Markdown?

Markdown is a lightweight way to format text using plain characters. Instead of clicking a "Bold" button, you type `**bold**`. Instead of inserting a heading from a menu, you type `#` `My Heading`.

Markdown files end in `.md` and look like plain text when opened in any editor, but render as formatted documents in Obsidian, GitHub, and most documentation sites.

A quick reference:

```
# Heading 1
## Heading 2

**bold text**
*italic text*

- bullet item
- another item

[link text](https://example.com)

![image alt text](path/to/image.png)
```

Initial Setup

Step 1 — Prerequisites: Git must be installed on your computer

Obsidian Git relies on the system Git binary to operate. Check whether Git is already installed before continuing.

Mac:

Git is usually pre-installed. Open **Terminal** (press `Cmd+Space`, type `Terminal`, press Enter) and run:

```
git --version
```

If you see a version number (e.g. `git version 2.39.0`), you are ready. If you see an error or a prompt to install Xcode Command Line Tools, click **Install** and wait for it to finish.

Windows:

Git is usually not installed by default. Download and run the installer from git-scm.com/downloads.

After installing, you do not need to open Git again — Obsidian will use it automatically.

Step 2 — Create a GitHub Personal Access Token

You need this token to authenticate with GitHub.

1. Go to github.com/settings/tokens
 2. Click **Generate new token** → **Generate new token (classic)**
 3. Under **Select scopes**, check the box next to **repo** (this covers all permissions needed)
 4. Scroll down and click **Generate token**
 5. **Copy the token now** — GitHub only shows it once. Paste it into a text file or password manager temporarily.
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Step 3 — Install Obsidian

1. Go to obsidian.md website and download and install the program
 2. Open Obsidian — on the welcome screen, click **Create new vault**
 3. Give the vault any name (e.g. `wiki`) and choose where to save it
 4. Click **Create**
-

Step 4 — Install the Obsidian Git plugin

1. In Obsidian, open **Settings** (gear icon, bottom-left)
 2. Go to **Community plugins**
 3. Click **Browse**
 4. Search for `Obsidian Git`
 5. Click the result by **Vinzent03**, then click **Install**, then **Enable**
-

Step 5 — Install the obsidian-github-tools plugin

1. In the same **Community plugins** → **Browse** screen, search for `GitHub Tools`
 2. Click the result by **kwhittle**, then click **Install**, then **Enable**
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Step 6 — Authenticate Obsidian Git with GitHub

1. In Obsidian, go to **Settings** → **Community plugins**, find **Git**, and click its gear icon
 2. Scroll to the **Authentication/Commit Author** section
 3. Enter your GitHub username in the **Username** field
 4. Paste your Personal Access Token (from Step 2) in the **Password/Token** field
 5. Fill in your name and email in the **Author name** and **Author email** fields (these appear on commits)
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Step 7 — Clone the repository into Obsidian

1. Open the **Command palette** (press `Ctrl+P` on Windows or `Cmd+P` on Mac)
2. Type `clone` and select **Obsidian Git: Clone an existing remote repo**
3. Paste the repository URL followed by `.git`
Example: `https://github.com/your-org/your-repo.git`
4. When asked for a path, leave it blank and press Enter (clones into the current vault folder)

After restarting, all the repository files will appear in the left sidebar.

Step 8 — Configure obsidian-github-tools

1. In Obsidian, go to **Settings** → **Community plugins**, find **GitHub Tools**, and click its gear icon
 2. In the **Local repo path** field, enter the full path to your vault folder
Example: `C:\Users\yourname\Documents\my-project` (Windows) or
`/Users/yourname/Documents/my-project` (Mac)
 3. In the **GitHub personal access token** field, paste your token from Step 2
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Editing Documents

Step 1 — Create a new branch from main

A branch is your own private workspace. Your changes are kept separate from everyone else's work until you decide to submit them for review.

Name your branch using your name and today's date, so it is easy to identify who is working on what.

Format: `firstname-lastname-YYYY-MM-DD`

Examples: `jane-smith-2026-08-19`, `alex-jones-2026-11-03`

To create the branch:

1. First, make sure you are starting from the latest version of `main`. Open the **Command palette** (`Ctrl+P` / `Cmd+P`), type `checkout`, and select **Obsidian Git: Switch to remote branch** — choose `main` from the list.
2. Open the Command palette again, type `create new branch`, and select **Obsidian Git: Create new branch**
3. Type your branch name in the format above (e.g. `jane-smith-2026-08-19`) and press Enter

The branch name now appears in the bottom status bar of Obsidian. You are ready to work.

Step 2 — Write, edit, and push your changes

Use the left sidebar to navigate files. Click any `.md` file to open it.

Switching between editing modes:

- **Live Preview** (default): shows formatted output as you type, like a word processor
- **Source mode**: shows raw Markdown syntax

To toggle, click the book icon in the top-right corner of the editor, or open the Command palette and type `toggle live preview`.

Push your changes regularly — ideally at least once a day.

Pushing saves your work to GitHub as a cloud backup. You do not need to be finished to push — push whenever you want to save your progress.

To push:

1. Click the **source control icon** in the left ribbon (branch/arrows icon) — this opens the Source Control panel
2. You will see a list of your changed files
3. In the **Commit message** box at the top of the panel, type a brief note on what you worked on
Examples: `Draft section 2`, `Work in progress — FAQ page`, `End of day backup`
4. Click the **Commit-and-sync** button (cloud/upload icon at the top of the panel)

Your work is now safely backed up to GitHub on your branch.

***Shortcut:** There is also a single Git ribbon button at the very top of the left sidebar. Hover over it to confirm the tooltip says "Commit-and-sync", then click it to push with one click using your last commit message.*

Step 3 — Submit your work for review

When you have finished a section and are ready for it to be reviewed, open a Pull Request (PR). A PR is a request for the maintainer to review your branch and merge it into the main documentation.

1. Make sure you have pushed all your latest changes (**Step 2**)
2. Click the **GitHub Tools** icon in the left sidebar (the GitHub logo) to open its panel
3. Click **Create PR**
4. A modal appears pre-filled with a title based on your branch name — edit the title to briefly describe what this PR contains
Examples: Jane Smith — Add FAQ section, Alex Jones — Update installation guide
5. Click **Create** — your browser opens to the GitHub Pull Request page, already filled in
6. (*Optional*) Add a short description in the text box explaining what you worked on and anything the reviewer should know
7. Click **Create pull request**

The maintainer will receive a notification and will review, request changes, or approve and merge your work.

Once you have submitted your PR, **do not keep editing on the same branch** — that branch is now under review.

Go back to **Step 1** and create a new branch with today's date to continue working on another section.

What happens after your PR is submitted?

- The maintainer reviews your changes on GitHub
- If changes are requested, you will get an email notification from GitHub
- To make edits: switch back to your original branch in Obsidian (Command palette → **Switch to remote branch** → select your branch), make the changes, push, and the PR updates automatically
- Once merged, your content will be pushed to the live site

Troubleshooting

"Push rejected" or authentication error

Your token may have expired. Generate a new one following the token steps in Part 1 above and update it in both the Obsidian Git settings (Settings → Git → Password/Token) and the obsidian-github-tools settings.

"Cannot push to this branch" / branch is protected

You are likely trying to push directly to `main`. Make sure you created a new branch in Step 1 of the workflow before making changes. Check the branch name in the bottom status bar — if it says `main`, open the Command palette and run **Obsidian Git: Create new branch** to start a fresh branch.

I submitted a PR but want to keep editing on that same branch

Once a PR is open, start a new branch (Step 1) for any additional work. Do not continue adding commits to a branch that is under review — it makes the review harder to follow. The reviewer will let you know if any fixes are needed on the existing PR.

Files I edited are not showing up in Commit-and-sync

Open the Command palette and run **Obsidian Git: Open source control view** to see the current status. Files in red are modified but not yet staged.

The GitHub Tools sidebar is not visible

Open the Command palette and search for `GitHub Tools` to find the command to open its panel.

I lost my branch or accidentally switched

Open the Command palette and run **Obsidian Git: Switch to remote branch** or **Create new branch** to get back on track. Ask the maintainer if you are unsure.